SUSE partners with Intel and SAP to accelerate IT transformation

SUSE, a pioneer in open source software, has announced support for the Intel Optane DC persistent memory with SAP HANA.

Running on the SUSE Linux enterprise server for SAP applications, SAP HANA users can now take advantage of the high-capacity Intel Optane DC persistent memory in the data centre. They can optimise their workloads by moving and maintaining larger amounts of data closer to the processor, and minimising the higher latency of fetching data from system storage during maintenance.

Support for Intel Optane DC persistent memory, currently available in beta from multiple cloud service providers and hardware vendors, is another way SUSE is helping customers transform their IT infrastructures to reduce costs, deliver higher performance and compete more efficiently.

"Persistent memory technology will spark new applications for data access and storage," says Thomas Di Giacomo, CTO, SUSE.

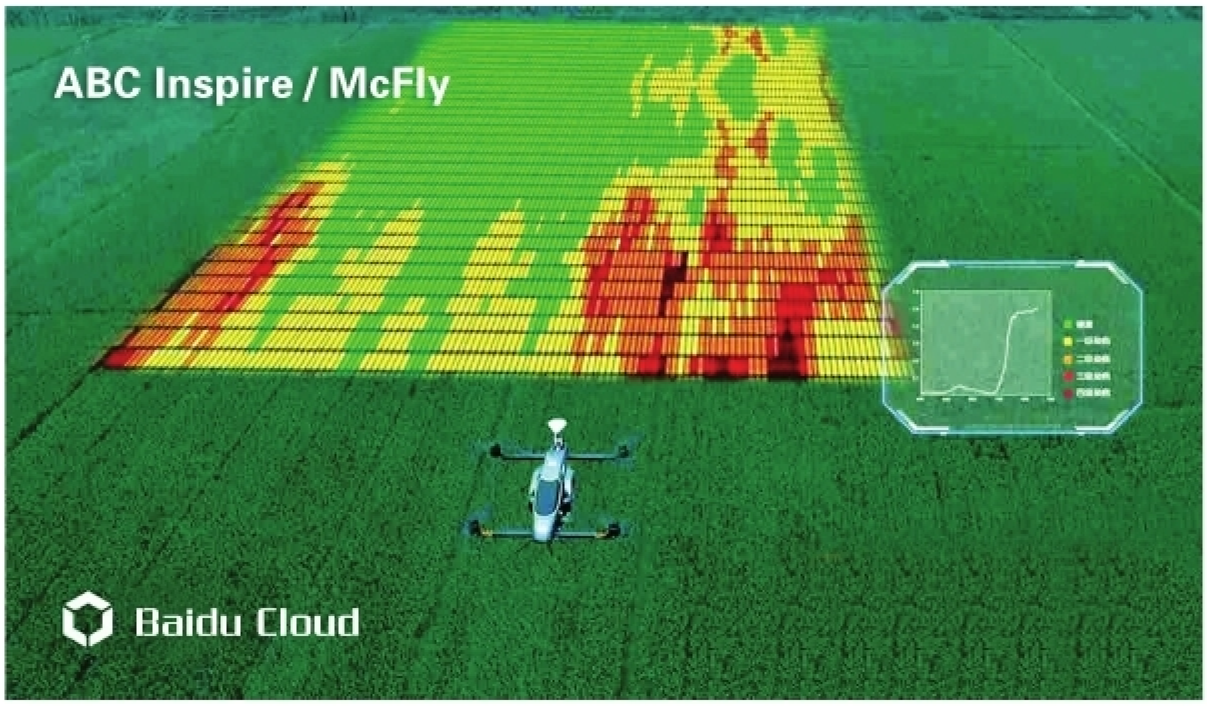
"By offering a fully supported solution built on the Intel Optane DC persistent memory, businesses can take greater advantage of the performance of SAP HANA. SUSE continues to partner with companies like SAP and Intel to serve customers worldwide who are looking to fuel growth by transforming their IT infrastructure. It is their needs that drive the direction of our innovation," Thomas adds.

According to Alper Ilkbahar, vice president and general manager of the non-volatile memory and storage solutions group at Intel, the Intel Optane DC persistent memory represents a new class of memory and storage technology architected specifically for data centre usage.

Baidu unveils open source edge computing platform at CES

At CES 2019 in Las Vegas, Chinese technology giant Baidu Inc. announced an open source edge computing platform, called OpenEdge, that enables developers to build edge applications and solutions with greater flexibility.

With OpenEdge, developers can build their own edge computing systems and deploy them on a variety of different hardware. These locally deployed systems will automatically be enabled with important features such as artificial intelligence, cloud synchronisation, data collection, function compute and message distribution, sources in Baidu say.



Watson Yin, vice president and general manager of Baidu Cloud, says that the growth of IoT devices and AI is leading to greater demand for edge computing.

"Edge computing is a critical component of Baidu's ABC (AI, Big Data and cloud computing) strategy. By moving the compute closer to the source of the data, it greatly reduces the latency, lowers the bandwidth usage and ultimately brings real-time and immersive experiences to end users. And by providing an open source platform, we have also greatly simplified the process for developers to create their own edge computing applications," Yin adds.

OpenEdge, which the company claims is China's first open source edge computing platform, is the local package component of the company's commercial software product, Baidu Intelligent Edge (BIE).

The BIE platform underpinning OpenEdge offers a cloud based management suite to manage edge nodes, edge apps, and resources such as certifications, passwords and program code. This means that BIE installed applications will be able to take advantage of both cloud reliability and edge locality.

BIE also works seamlessly with Baidu Cloud and supports models trained on mainstream AI frameworks such as PaddlePaddle and TensorFlow. This means that developers can train their AI models on BIE and then deploy them on local devices.

Besides OpenEdge, Baidu also announced two new AI hardware development platforms—the BIE-AI-Box, a kit for in-car video analysis designed in partnership with Intel; and the BIE-AI-Board, a chipboard co-developed with NXP Semiconductors that's optimised for object classification.

The BIE-AI-Box connects with cameras in vehicles to optimise video analysis and will provide AI apps for road recognition, car body monitoring and driver behaviour recognition, Baidu sources say.

The BIE-AI-Board can be installed on devices such as drones, robots and cameras, and perform a variety of detection tasks, the company adds.